Roman Key Card Blackwood - 1430 version

RKCB is similar to Blackwood, but instead of four Aces there are Five Keycards. They are the Aces plus the King of the agreed trump suit. Starting with 4NT, a reply of 5♣ shows 1 or 4 Keycards, 5♦ shows 0 or 3, 5♥ shows 2 Keycards but no trump Queen, and 5♠ shows 2 Keycards with the trump Queen.
If your side has all five Keycards, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings, remembering that there are only three Kings since the trump King is counted as a Keycard. There are two popular methods for responding to 5NT. The first is the same as normal Blackwood - 6♣ shows no Kings, 6♦ shows one, and 6♥ shows three. This is the method used in the recommended bidding here.
If the response to 4NT is 5♣ or 5♦ the 4NT bidder may choose to ask about the trump Queen rather than ask for Kings. She does this by bidding the cheapest non-trump suit. Partner denies the trump Queen by returning to the trump suit. A 5NT bid confirms the trump Queen, but shows no outside Kings. Bidding any non-trump suit confirms the trump Queen and also the King of the suit bid.
Void showing by Responder is handled just as in regular Blackwood except it refers to one or two Keycards, rather than one or two Aces.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 5♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣10

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣7

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣4

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥4

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♦
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣7

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q J 9 6 ♥ 4 ♦ K Q J 7 ♣ A K Q	
♠ 5 2 ♥ K 9 6 5 ♦ A 4 3 ♣ 10 9 8 6	N W E S	♠ 10 7 3 ♥ Q J 10 2 ♦ 8 6 2 ♣ J 4 3
	♠ A 8 4 ♥ A 8 7 3 ♦ 10 9 5 ♣ 7 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

6♠ by North
Lead: ♥Q

2NT shows a balanced hand with 8+ points, and when SOUTH then supports ♠s NORTH makes a slam try.

NORTH bids RKC Blackwood 4NT. SOUTH shows two Keycards (two Aces) and NORTH bids 6♠.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 9 8 2 ♥ 9 6 ♦ 8 6 4 ♣ J 8 6 3	
♠ K J ♥ Q J 8 5 ♦ Q 10 9 7 ♣ Q 4 2		♠ A Q 7 ♥ K 10 7 4 2 ♦ K J 3 ♣ A K
	♠ 6 5 4 3 ♥ A 3 ♦ A 5 2 ♣ 10 9 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♦[2]	Pass	5♥	
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

5♥ by East
Lead: ♣10

WEST has a decent Limit Raise, and EAST tries RKC Blackwood.

WEST replies to the 4NT bid with 5♦, zero or three Keycards. So which is it, zero or three?

Pretty simple - since EAST holds three Keycards himself WEST can hardly have three also since there are only five total. She must have zero and EAST signs off at 5♥.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 10 7 4 ♥ K Q J 8 4 ♦ A 6 ♣ A 3	
♠ 9 5 ♥ 10 9 7 6 ♦ J 9 4 3 2 ♣ 7 6		♠ J ♥ A 3 2 ♦ 10 8 5 ♣ J 10 9 8 4 2
	♠ A Q 8 6 3 2 ♥ 5 ♦ K Q 7 ♣ K Q 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣7

NORTH jumps to 4♠, confident that SOUTH could make 10 tricks even if he just has 6 points.

SOUTH knows he can make more and bids RKCB 4NT.

NORTH's 5♦ response shows zero or three Keycards. So which is it? Zero or three?

NORTH bid much too strongly to have no Aces. SOUTH bids a confident 6♠, knowing NORTH has either three Aces or two Aces plus the ♠K.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ Q 10 8 4 2 ♥ 2 ♦ Q J 7 3 ♣ 8 7 4	
♠ 6 ♥ A K 9 7 5 4 ♦ 6 ♣ K Q J 10 3		♠ A 7 5 ♥ Q 10 8 3 ♦ A 8 5 4 ♣ 9 2
	♠ K J 9 3 ♥ J 6 ♦ K 10 9 2 ♣ A 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by West
Lead: ♣4

With eleven cards in the "round" suits WEST has a lot of playing strength. So when EAST bids a Limit Raise in ♥s WEST wants to know about Aces.

RKCBlackwood tells him that EAST has two Aces plus the trump Queen, so WEST can see that 6♥ is practically a certainty.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 9 8 4 2
♥ K Q 10 6
♦ 8 4
♣ A

♠ 6 5
♥ 8 3
♦ K Q 9 7
♣ J 10 5 3 2



♠ 10
♥ 9 7 4 2
♦ A J 5
♣ Q 9 8 7 6

♠ Q J 7 3
♥ A J 5
♦ 10 6 3 2
♣ K 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥4

NORTH has interest in slam after she hears SOUTH's Limit Raise. BUT, she should not use Blackwood holding two quick losers in the ♦ suit.

Instead she makes a Control showing bid of 4♣. (Not Gerber since it didn't follow a NT bid.)

SOUTH cooperates by making a Control bid of 4♥.

NORTH stops at 4♠ because neither partner controls ♦s.

Board 6
West Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 4 2
♥ 10 4 3
♦ 5
♣ 10 9 5 3 2

♠ 6
♥ K Q 8 7 2
♦ A K 9 6 3
♣ K Q



♠ A J 7
♥ J 6
♦ Q J 10 8 7
♣ A 6 4

♠ K 9 8 5 3
♥ A 9 5
♦ 4 2
♣ J 8 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	2♦	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]	Pass
6♦			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♦ by East
Lead: ♣7

WEST decides it is unlikely that EAST is Aceless, so all he wants to know is the number of Aces EAST does have. He invokes RKC Blackwood.

Since no trump suit has been agreed, EAST bids as if ♦s, the last-bid suit prior to 4NT is agreed. EAST has two Key-cards plus the trump Queen, so she bids 5♠.

WEST bids 6♦. If EAST had just one Key-card, WEST would bid 5♦ over the 5♣ reply.